

# Overlay Guides

## by FlorindoLAB

Composition guides on top of
any software.

**User guide**

Version 1.1.0

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# Overview

**Overlay Guides** displays composition guides (rule of thirds, golden ratio, diagonals, center cross, golden triangle, golden spiral) in a **transparent window** placed over your working area: Blender, an editing application, a video player… Frame your shot, compare it, check your camera axes, without changing anything in your software.

## WHAT IT DOES

### 6 combinable guides

Rule of thirds, golden ratio, diagonals, center cross, golden triangle and golden spiral, each with its own color.

### 3 draggable markers

Numbered circles you can place anywhere, to compare your camera axes.

### Multiple overlays

One tab per overlay, each with its own identification color and its own on/off switch.

### Click-through mode

Ctrl+Alt+G: clicks pass through the overlay to the software underneath.

### Window layer

Overlay another window (an exported shot, for instance) with adjustable opacity.

### Settings remembered

Guides, colors, window position and size are kept from one session to the next.

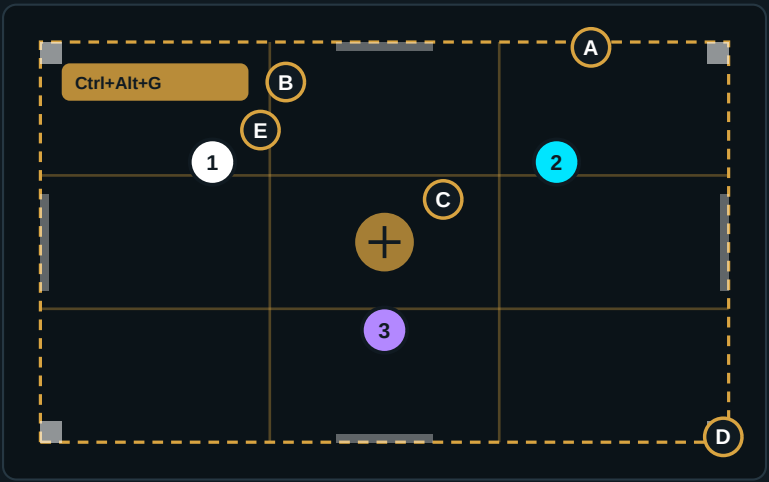
## REQUIREMENTS

- Windows 10 or 11 (64-bit)
- No installation, no .NET to install
- Works offline
- Interface in French and English (FR / EN buttons)

# Getting started

1. Run **OverlayGuides.exe**. The control panel and a first overlay open.
2. Place the overlay over your working area: the **round handle** in the center moves it, the **corners** and **edges** resize it.
3. Turn on the guides you want in the panel and pick their colors.
4. Press **Ctrl+Alt+G**: the overlay switches to click-through and you work normally in your software. The same shortcut brings back the interactive mode.

## ANATOMY OF THE GUIDES WINDOW (INTERACTIVE MODE)




- **A** Dashed frame, in the overlay's color: it marks the limits of the area.
- **B** Badge reminding the Ctrl+Alt+G shortcut.
- **C** Round handle: drag it to move the window.
- **D** Corners and edges: drag them to resize.
- **E** Numbered markers, to drag anywhere you like.

> In click-through mode, all this “chrome” disappears: only the guides and markers remain.

## QUICK REFERENCE

| | |
|---|---|
| Move an overlay | **Drag the round handle in the center** |
| Resize an overlay | **Drag a corner or an edge** |
| Place a marker | **Drag the numbered circle** |
| Turn click-through on / off | **Ctrl+Alt+G** |
| Change the language | **FR / EN buttons in the panel** |

# The guides



### Rule of thirds

Two vertical and two horizontal lines split the image into nine equal areas. Place important elements on the lines or at their intersections.



### Golden ratio

Lines placed at about 38% and 62% of the width and height: a variant closer to the center than the rule of thirds.



### Diagonals

The two diagonals of the image: useful for spotting vanishing lines and strong directions in the frame.



### Center cross

The vertical and horizontal axes through the center: to center an element or check a symmetry.



### Golden triangle

One diagonal and two perpendicular lines from the two other corners cut the image into triangles. The “Flip” button shows the mirrored version.



### Golden spiral

A spiral built on the golden ratio, which leads the eye toward a point of interest. Two buttons flip it horizontally or vertically.

**Shared settings:** line thickness, line opacity and background dimming apply to all the guides of an overlay. The **color** is chosen guide by guide (swatch at the right of each row).

# Markers, tabs and window layer

## Markers

Up to **3 numbered circles**, to drag anywhere in the overlay. They help you compare the position of an element along your camera axes. Each marker has its own color; “Reset positions” puts them back. Their position is relative to the window: they stay at the same logical spot if you resize it.

## Multiple overlays (tabs)

The **“+ New overlay”** button creates an independent overlay in a new tab: its own guides, markers, style and layer. Each overlay has an **identification color** (tab dot, dashed frame of its window).

**Ctrl+Alt+G** applies to the overlay whose tab is selected. The **“Overlay active”** switch hides the overlay without closing it; the tab's **×** closes it. Closing the last tab quits the application.

## Window layer

Overlay the content of another window, for example an already exported shot open in a player, to compare it with your working viewport.

1. Turn on **“Enable layer”**.
2. Click **“Choose a window…”** and select it in the list.
3. Adjust the layer **opacity**.

**Single capture** (default): one image of the window, updated with “Refresh capture”. It is lightweight and enough in most cases.
**Real time**: about 10 frames per second in a loop. Handy for comparing, but it is not a smooth video player.

Depending on the application, some windows may appear empty or black when captured. The chosen window is not remembered from one session to the next.

## Tip

Create one overlay per use: for example a first one with the rule of thirds for framing, a second one with the layer of an exported shot for comparing. Each keeps its own settings, and the “Overlay active” switch lets you show or hide them with one click.

# Frequently asked questions

### Windows shows “Windows protected your PC” on first launch.

The file is not yet signed with a certificate recognized by Microsoft: Windows is cautious with new software that few people have downloaded. Click **More info**, then **Run anyway**. Some antivirus programs may also be cautious.

### How do I check that my file is authentic?

Compare its SHA-256 hash with the one on the download page. In PowerShell:

```
Get-FileHash .\OverlayGuides.exe -Algorithm SHA256
```

### The overlay does not appear over my software.

It may not display over an exclusive full-screen application: switch it to windowed or borderless full-screen mode. Also check that “Overlay active” is turned on.

### I can no longer click inside the overlay.

It is in click-through mode. Select its tab in the panel and press Ctrl+Alt+G again.

### The Ctrl+Alt+G shortcut does not respond.

It applies to the overlay whose tab is selected. If nothing happens, another program may already be using this key combination.

### Where are my settings saved? How do I reset them?

In the file below. Close the application and delete it to start from scratch:

```
%AppData%\OverlayGuides\config.json
```

### How do I uninstall?

There is no installation: delete OverlayGuides.exe and, if you wish, the %AppData%\OverlayGuides folder.

Overlay Guides is **free** (freeware, closed source); the full license is on florindolab.com. I develop my tools in my spare time: if this one is useful to you, you can support me on ko-fi.com/florindolab. To report a bug or suggest an idea: florindolab.com · Instagram @florindolab.